- To initialize a nurse- patient relationship
- To plan intervention accordingly.
- To plan health education according to the information gathered.

"Don't be afraid of the information you are going to start seeing. You will have better insight and probably learn more about your patients, thus building a far better relationship with your patient than you may have thought possible."

## 6.4 METHODS OF PHYSICAL EXAMINATION

Describe how to perform inspection, palpation, percussion, and auscultation, and which areas of the body are assessed with each technique.

Techniques in physical assessment are:

### 6.4.1 Inspection

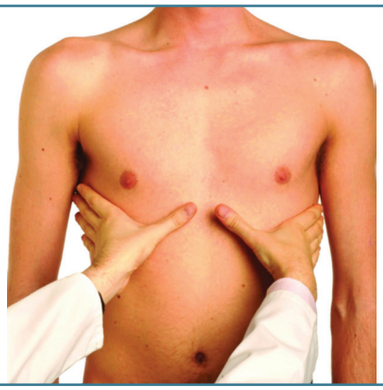
It means looking with eyes. It reveals any rash, scar, colour, size, shape, contour and symmetry of the body parts.



**Inspection**

### 6.4.2 Palpation

It means feeling using sense of touch. It reveals any swelling, coldness, hotness, stiffness, hardness, smoothness, roughness, pain, vibration, firmness and flaccidity.



**Palpation**

### 6.4.3 Percussion

It means striking or tapping with fingers. It elicits sounds which indicate whether the underlined tissues are solid or filled with fluid. The sounds may vary with varied conclusion.



**Percussion**

The sounds may vary.

- **Resonant:** A loud sound over the normal lung tissue.
- **Tympanic:** A drum like sound over the air-filled tissues such as gastric air bubble.
- **Dull:** A medium pitched sound with medium duration without resonance, heard over the solid tissue, such as heart, liver.
- **Flat:** A pitched sound with short duration without resonance, heard over the complete solid tissue, such as bones.



Nursing-voc_Unit 06.indd 173 22-02-2019 4.45.55 PM